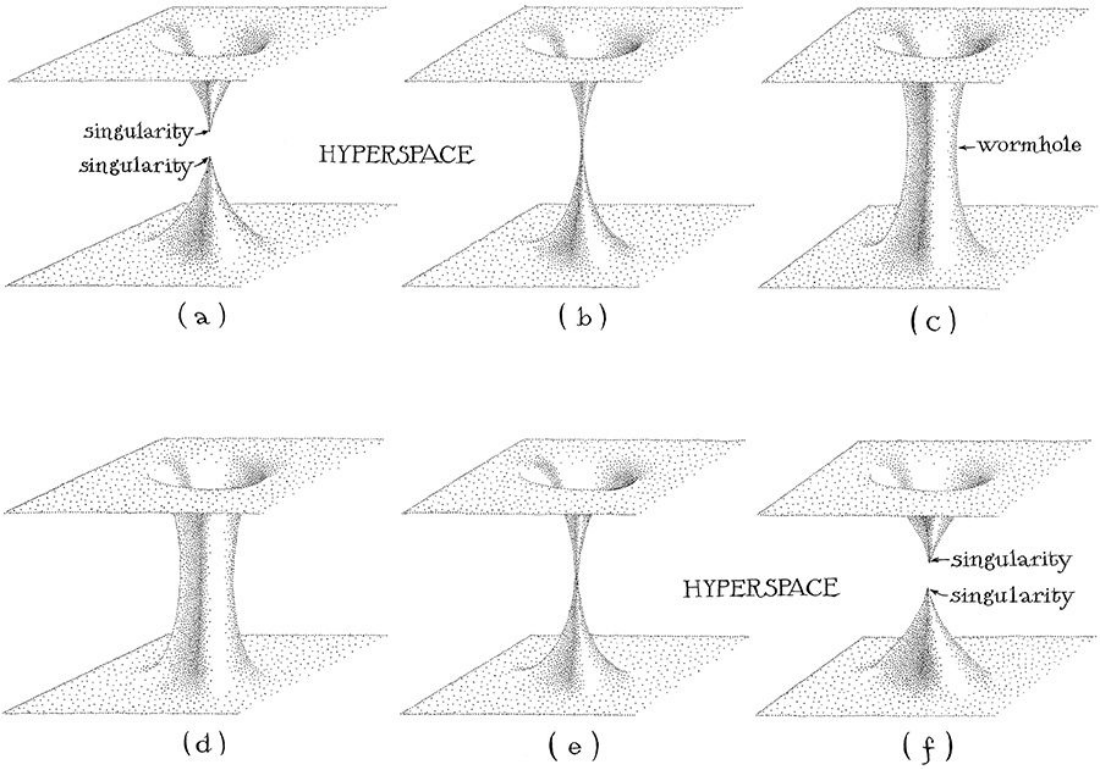


Fig. 14.3. Dynamics of Flamm's wormhole (the Einstein-Rosen bridge). *[Drawing by Matt Zimet based on a sketch by me; from my book* Black Holes & Time Warps: Einstein's Outrageous Legacy.*]*

This prediction is inescapable. If the universe were ever, somehow, to develop a spherical wormhole that contains no gravitating matter, this is how the wormhole would behave. Einstein's relativistic laws dictate it.

Wheeler was not dismayed by this conclusion. On the contrary, he was pleased. He regarded singularities (places where space and time are infinitely warped) as a "crisis" for the laws of physics. And crises are wonderful tutors. By probing wisely, we can get great insights into the physical laws. To this I return in Chapter 26.

Contact